

## God is everything: A journey from belief to realisation

This is not my **conjecture**. Lord Krishna **states**, “After the efforts of many births, a yogi in the end becomes **wise**, and he takes My shelter. **A great soul**, who considers Lord Vasudeva thus as everything, **is** very rare.” (The Bhagavad Gita 7.19) What message comes through from the next very famous **verse** translated into English? “You only are my mother and you only are my father. You only are my relative and friend, you only are my knowledge and **wealth**, you only are my all, my God of Gods.” I scanned the internet about this matter. What did I find? Different religions have the same message. The entire universe is viewed as a **manifestation** of God. We souls are parts of God. (15.7) Sikhs believe that God is everything. Christians believe in God’s **omnipresence**. Islam believes that Allah is the **sole** source of all creation.

My main source of knowledge is the Bhagavad Gita. What have I learnt? Lord Krishna states, “Whatever there is **opulent, effulgent** or even energetic, all that you should know as produced from a fragment of My **splendour**.” (10.41) Arjuna describes what he saw in the Vishwaroop of Lord Krishna: “O Lord of the universe, I see Your **innumerable** forms on all sides, having many hands, **bellies**, mouths, and eyes; I do not see Your end, nor middle, not even Your beginning.” (11.16) “I see You without beginning, middle or end; of unlimited strength; having numberless hands, having eyes like the moon and the sun; having the mouth burning like fire; and **scorching** this universe by Your own **radiance**.” (11.19) Lord Krishna confirms, “Having limbs on all sides; having eyes, head and mouth on all sides; having ears on all sides, God is situated in this world, **pervading** all.” (13.13) “He only is outside and inside of all living entities, in non-moving and moving too; unknown due to being **subtle**, and situated far away also, and nearby too; it is He only.” (13.15) I can go on, but will **summarise** briefly what I have learnt about God. He is **omnipotent**, i.e., all-powerful; **omniscient**, i.e., knows past, present and even future, besides all that is knowable; **omnipresent**, i.e., present everywhere all the time. God is the source of everything; He is, in fact, the **essence** of all existence. God **encompasses** everything; we are living within God. God is the Creator and very much involved in its **continuation** for millions of years.

Believe it or not, **God**, in spite of what has been described earlier, **is** waiting for us to turn to Him. Lord Krishna states, “Four kinds of **virtuous** people worship Me. These are a **distressed** person, an **inquisitive** person, a seeker of wealth and a wise person.” (7.16) Surely, we fit in at least one category, if not two or three. Who is not struggling to exist well in this ‘dukhalaya’ (place of **misery** – 8.15)? Aren’t we all desirous of material objects, mostly money? And some of us are inquisitive about God. Wise persons are few, and they have already taken shelter of God. I will state my experiences about how I benefitted by taking active shelter of God and how I managed it. Long back, I realised that **material objects** like lots of money and sense enjoyments **pleased** but did not satisfy. (3.39) Most of all, I needed to be peaceful to be satisfied and happy. Fortunately, my grandfather, grandmother, father and mother were all devotees of God in various ways. I had good saskaras (cultural values) to

**emulate**. I did, and started doing spiritual practices, beginning with **chanting** mantras and the Lord's names.

As I began to get a response from God, I took up many more spiritual practices, like praying sincerely. I **hung** a large photo of Lord Krishna on the right side of my bed **in order to** have darsana — to see my Lord easily and frequently. This led to namana (offering **obeisance**). By now I was becoming God-conscious. I started seeking guidance and help in all matters **concerning** me, and God was responding like I could have never imagined. Obviously, I was very thankful, which I expressed **gratefully**. My spiritual writing began to **flourish**. It was some experience with God inspiring me to write, helping me to put the text together, and getting my articles and books printed and uploaded. Life became completely different and, yes, very satisfying. **God**, who is everything, **was** proving to me how He could guide and help in all matters. Challenges came, as they do, and I was able to deal with them successfully under God's **micromanagement**. Life has progressed from almost nothing to quite something.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

## Vocabulary

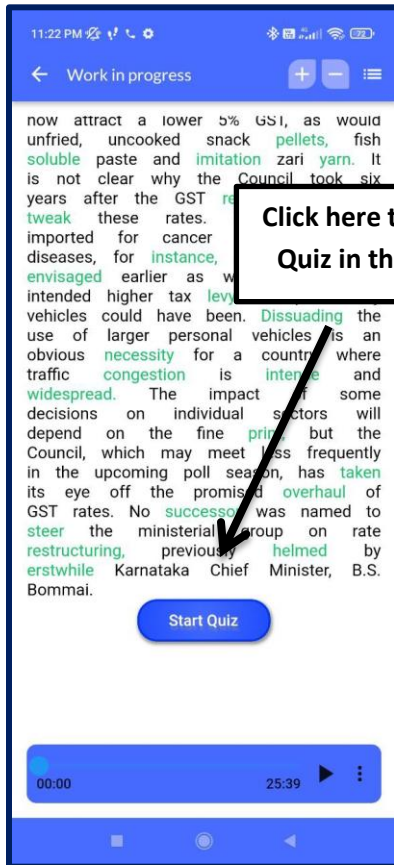
1. **Conjecture** (noun) – Guess, speculation, assumption, hypothesis, surmise अनुमान
2. **State** (verb) – Declare, announce, affirm, proclaim, assert कहना/घोषणा करना
3. **Verse** (noun) – Stanza, line, passage, couplet, poem श्लोक/पंक्ति
4. **Wealth** (noun) – Riches, assets, fortune, prosperity, abundance संपत्ति
5. **Manifestation** (noun) – Display, expression, revelation, demonstration, embodiment प्रकटीकरण
6. **Omnipresence** (noun) – Ubiquity, universality, presence everywhere, all-pervasiveness, boundlessness सर्वव्यापकता
7. **Sole** (adjective) – Only, single, exclusive, lone, solitary अकेला/एकमात्र
8. **Opulent** (adjective) – Luxurious, lavish, rich, splendid, grand भव्य/समृद्ध
9. **Effulgent** (adjective) – Radiant, shining, brilliant, luminous, dazzling तेजस्वी
10. **Splendour** (noun) – Magnificence, grandeur, brilliance, glory, majesty वैभव/भव्यता
11. **Innumerable** (adjective) – Countless, limitless, infinite, myriad, numberless असंख्य
12. **Belly** (noun) – Stomach, abdomen, tummy, midriff, paunch पेट
13. **Scorch** (verb) – Burn, sear, char, singe, blister झुलसाना
14. **Radiance** (noun) – Brightness, glow, brilliance, luminosity, shine चमक/तेज
15. **Pervade** (verb) – Spread, permeate, fill, saturate, diffuse व्याप्त होना
16. **Subtle** (adjective) – Delicate, faint, slight, nuanced, elusive सूक्ष्म
17. **Summarise** (verb) – Condense, recap, sum up, outline, review संक्षेप करना
18. **Omnipotent** (adjective) – All-powerful, almighty, supreme, invincible, unlimited सर्वशक्तिमान
19. **Omniscient** (adjective) – All-knowing, wise, knowledgeable, sagacious, perceptive सर्वज्ञ
20. **Omnipresent** (adjective) – Present everywhere, ubiquitous, universal, pervasive, boundless सर्वव्यापी
21. **Essence** (noun) – Core, soul, heart, substance, nature सार
22. **Encompass** (verb) – Include, surround, cover, encircle, embrace समेटना

23. **Continuation** (noun) – Persistence, prolongation, perpetuation, extension, maintenance निरंतरता
24. **Virtuous** (adjective) – Moral, righteous, ethical, good, noble सदाचारी
25. **Distressed** (adjective) – Troubled, upset, anguished, worried, agitated परेशान/दुखी
26. **Inquisitive** (adjective) – Curious, questioning, probing, inquiring, eager-to-know जिज्ञासु
27. **Misery** (noun) – Suffering, distress, unhappiness, agony, anguish दुख
28. **Please** (verb) – Satisfy, delight, gratify, content, amuse प्रसन्न करना
29. **Emulate** (verb) – Imitate, follow, copy, mirror, model अनुकरण करना
30. **Chant** (verb) – Recite, sing, intone, repeat, hymn जाप करना
31. **Hang** (verb) – Suspend, dangle, fix, attach, place लटकाना
32. **In order to** (phrase) – To, so as to, with the purpose of, for the sake of, aiming to के लिए
33. **Obeisance** (noun) – Bow, respect, reverence, salutation, homage नमन/प्रणाम
34. **Concern** (verb) – Worry, relate to, affect, involve, regard संबंधित होना/चिंता करना
35. **Gratefully** (adverb) – Thankfully, appreciatively, obligedly, appreciatively, indebtedly कृतज्ञतापूर्वक
36. **Flourish** (verb) – Thrive, prosper, bloom, grow, succeed फलना-फूलना
37. **Micromanagement** (noun) – Overcontrol, excessive supervision, minute regulation, detailed oversight, rigid control सूक्ष्म प्रबंधन

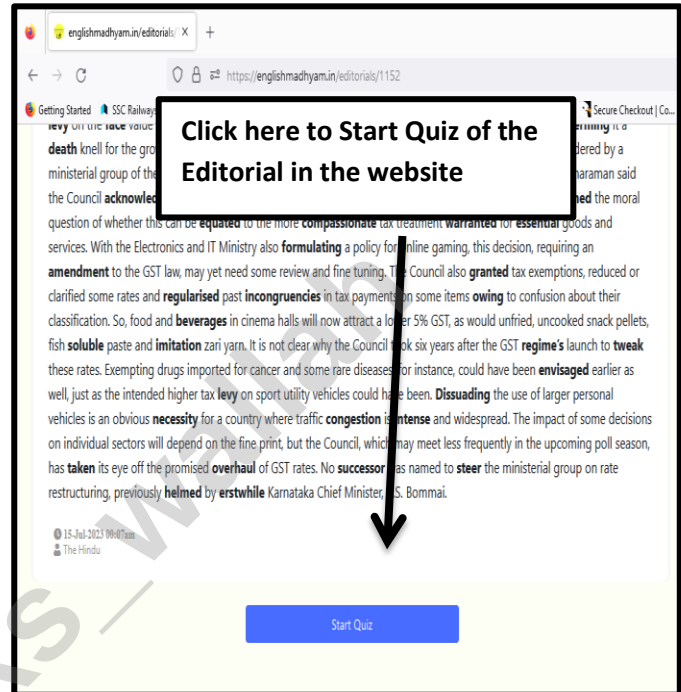
### Summary of the Editorial

1. The author starts by quoting Lord Krishna from the Bhagavad Gita, highlighting the rare soul who sees God as everything.
2. Another famous verse from the Gita underscores the all-encompassing nature of God as father, mother, friend, and everything else.
3. The author finds that all major religions—Hinduism, Sikhism, Christianity, Islam—share the idea of God's omnipresence and omnipotence.
4. The Bhagavad Gita serves as the author's main source of understanding God's universal and absolute nature.
5. Verses from the Gita describe God's cosmic form (Vishwaroop) with infinite limbs, eyes, and radiance, symbolizing God's limitless presence.
6. Lord Krishna's teachings assert that God pervades everything, existing inside and outside all beings, moving and non-moving.
7. The Gita reveals God as omnipotent (all-powerful), omniscient (all-knowing), and omnipresent (everywhere at once).
8. God is presented as the source, essence, and sustainer of the entire universe, deeply involved in its creation and continuation.
9. Despite His vastness, God waits for humans to turn to Him, welcoming four types of devotees: distressed, inquisitive, seekers of wealth, and wise.
10. The author argues everyone fits at least one category among these devotees, highlighting life's inherent struggles and desires.
11. The author's personal dissatisfaction with material pursuits led to the realization that peace and happiness require turning toward God.
12. Family influence, especially from spiritually inclined grandparents and parents, inspired the author's early spiritual practices.
13. Starting with chanting mantras and God's names, the author gradually deepened spiritual engagement.
14. Practices like praying sincerely, keeping Lord Krishna's photo nearby, and offering obeisance helped the author develop God-consciousness.
15. Through these spiritual practices, the author experienced divine guidance, found purpose in spiritual writing, overcame life's challenges, and attained a satisfying and fulfilling life under God's care.

## Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based



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